

Session 12: Genesis 1 Imagery in Psalm 104

Key Takeaways

- Creation is more about giving order, purpose, and function than it is about material origins (see Ps. 104).
- In Psalm 104, creation is ongoing, sustaining work.
- Creating can be used to describe the beginning, the middle, and the whole sustaining process.
- In Genesis, this means that “created” doesn’t necessarily have to mean made out of nothing. It could also mean giving life and purpose to something.

Exploring Creating in Psalm 104

We’ll explore the connection to Genesis 1 imagery in [Psalm 104](#), specifically the concept of creation. How does Psalm 104 help us to better understand creation in Genesis 1?

The *Ruakh* in Genesis 1

Genesis 1:2 NASB

The earth was formless and void, and darkness was over the surface of the deep, and the **Spirit of God** was moving over the surface of the waters.

In Hebrew, *ruakh Elohim* means Spirit of God, while *ruakh* means breath, wind, or spirit. It’s an invisible energy working through a personal, impersonal, or disembodied agent.

The *Ruakh* in Psalm 104

In Psalm 104, creation is ongoing, sustaining work. “Creating” can be used to describe the beginning, the middle, and the whole sustaining process.

Reflection Question

What does the word “create” mean in Psalm 104? What might this mean for Genesis 1, where it says “God created the heavens and the earth”?



Module 3: The Literary Design of Genesis 1

SESSIONS 13-15

The literary design and symmetry of Genesis 1 is some of the most exquisite in the Hebrew Bible. Let's dive in!